

TAWANDA GUNHA

Guesthouse Manager | Hospitality Operations | Guest Relations

Queenstown, South Africa | +27 72 814 3909 | tawandagunha7@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/tawanda-jospat-gunha-0598273b>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Hospitality Manager with over 10 years of experience leading guesthouse and hotel operations. Proven track record in managing a 28-room property, improving occupancy rates by 30%, and leading high-performing teams of up to 10 staff. Skilled in front office management, reservations systems, revenue optimization, and customer service excellence. Adept at handling international guests and delivering premium hospitality experiences.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Front Office and Guest Relations Management
- Reservations and Booking Systems (PMS)
- Hospitality Operations and Administration
- Staff Supervision, Training and Leadership
- Revenue Growth and Occupancy Optimization
- Customer Experience and Complaint Resolution
- Housekeeping and Facility Management
- Health, Safety and Compliance
- Budgeting and Financial Reporting
- Event Coordination and Guest Services

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Guesthouse Manager

Mentor Guesthouse – Queenstown, South Africa | Jun 2016 – Present

- Oversee full operations of a 28-room guesthouse, including front office, housekeeping, and guest services
- Lead, train, and schedule a team of 10 staff members, ensuring consistently high service standards
- Grew occupancy rates by 30% through targeted marketing campaigns and repeat guest retention strategies
- Maintain a weekly guest occupancy rate of 75%, reflecting strong demand and consistent service quality
- Handle guest check-ins, check-outs, and resolve customer complaints professionally and promptly
- Monitor expenses, prepare financial reports, and control operational costs to maximise profitability
- Uphold high guest satisfaction ratings through ongoing service quality improvements

Key Achievements:

- Boosted occupancy by 30% through strategic marketing and a strong repeat-guest programme
- Sustained a 75% weekly guest occupancy rate across a 28-room property
- Built and managed a cohesive team of 10 hospitality professionals, reducing staff turnover
- Enhanced overall guest satisfaction scores through service quality audits and staff coaching

Events Coordinator (Volunteer)

Adventure Travel – Gweru, Zimbabwe | Oct 2015 – May 2016

- Managed reservations and responded to international booking inquiries
- Coordinated event logistics including venues, catering, and suppliers
- Organised travel arrangements including airport transfers and activities
- Liaised with clients to ensure successful event delivery

Night Manager

Crane's Nest Guesthouse – Pretoria, South Africa | Oct 2014 – Sep 2015

- Managed night front office operations and guest services
- Processed reservations, payments, and guest requests efficiently
- Conducted security checks and ensured compliance with safety standards
- Supervised night staff and maintained operational continuity

EDUCATION

Diploma in Hotel Operations and Management

College of Professional Management, UK | 2008 – 2009

Diploma in Tourism and Travel Agency Management

College of Professional Management, UK | 1999 – 2000

LICENSES & CERTIFICATIONS

Saylor University

Issued Sep 2026

- BUS210: Business Communication · Credential ID: 4676022894TG
- BUS300: Operations Management · Credential ID: 8442234544TG
- BUS401: Management Leadership · Credential ID: 4012449514T

Alison | Issued Apr 2026

- Diploma in Business Administration · Credential ID: 3038-23980923
- Diploma in Customer Service · Credential ID: 1238-23980923
- Diploma in Hospitality and Tourism Management · Credential ID: 7594-23980923
- Diploma in Hospitality Management · Credential ID: 1259-23980923
- Hospitality Management Studies · Hotel Operations · Credential ID: 1385-23980923
- Food and Beverage Management · Credential ID: 6167-23980923

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Property Management Systems (PMS)
- Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, Outlook)
- Online Booking Platforms (Booking.com, Airbnb)

LANGUAGES

- English · Fluent
- Shona · Fluent

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Nationality: Zimbabwean
- Willing to relocate internationally
- South African Driver's Licence: Code 14 (EC)
- References available on request